COMING FULL CIRCLE

Five years after 'Enjoy Enjaami', Australian-Tamil singer DHEE has returned to her roots with a new Tamil single—and also has an upcoming English album

Five years ago, Australian-Tamil singer-songwriter Dhee released 'Enjoy Enjaami', a Tamil song featuring rapper Arivu that has been streamed over one billion times. While she remains a mainstay in the Tamil playback industry, 'Vari Vari' marks her return to independent Tamil music after five years. This gap wasn't an intentional delay, but rather Dhee's natural artistic evolution.

"'Enjoy Enjaami' was a bridge to my upcoming English album," Dhee reflects. "I felt like I haven't put out songs in Tamil in a long time. I really missed it. I've evolved as a songwriter in these five years." That longing to return to her roots resulted in a creative burst, giving birth to 'Vari Vari'. Although initially, she wanted her song to be about love—whether for a partner or child or a higher power—the song turned inward. "I was going through some personal events and the track evolved into a statement about being on your own journey and finding yourself and your inner child," she adds.

> Although initially she wanted her **song to be about love, it evolved to be about** looking for your inner child

Dhee's trajectory has been unmistakably global. She was part of 'Don't Look Down' with Ed Sheeran and Hanumankind and collaborated with Wondagurl and Tiwa Sawage for 'Ancient Seed'.

Dhee has a major partnership with Visva Records and Republic Records. Her ultimate reward has been seeing international powerhouses be open to South Asian rhythms. This willingness to step into unfamiliar territory fuels her to explore industries closer to home, like Hindi music. "I've sung one Hindi song—'Nain Matakka' in *Baby John*—but I am eager to explore more," she says.

She describes her upcoming English album *Jackfruit* as a bag of jelly beans, adding, "There are many different things going on. There's a lot of Tamil folk and a lot of storytelling in the album." ■

—Deepali Dhingra



GLOBAL FORCE *Dhee was part of 'Don't Look Down' with Ed Sheeran and Hanumankind*

The Listicle

Upcoming musical performances you should not miss



LUIGI CREESE

▲ **JUN. 25-26** | ***Windmills Craftworks,*** *Bengaluru;* **JUN. 27** | ***Windmills Craftworks,*** *Hyderabad*

Etienne Charles: Creole Soul

Acclaimed Trinidadian trumpeter and composer Etienne Charles brings Creole Soul to India, blending jazz, Caribbean traditions and cultural storytelling. Known for transforming overlooked histories into compelling musical narratives, Charles combines warm lyricism with rhythmic vitality, supported by an outstanding ensemble featuring saxophonist Godwin Louis and cuatro virtuoso Jorge Glem.

